



A Season of Thanksgiving



Dear Christ Church Members and Friends,

This November is a real “Season of Thanksgiving” for us, encompassing many aspects of our witness: a Thanksgiving Drive for Paterson, a kickoff for the Christmas Gift Drive for families in need and our 2022 Pledge Giving Drive, when we faithfully give back to God from our blessings.

Even with the challenges everyone has had the past year, God continues to guide our footsteps and Christ Church is strong and committed **thanks to all of you!**

In the past year, we have accomplished all of the following and more **together:**

- **Gathered in prayer Sundays at all 3 in-person services plus new mid-week offerings**
- **Fed those in need through monthly meals at the Shelter and our new financial and time support of Family Promise’s walk-in meals in addition to our renewed Share Sundays**
- **Brought back Fellowship opportunities sooner and larger than thought possible, such as the Parish Picnic with 90+ people, fuller coffee hours since summer & Annual Meeting**
- **Maintained our lively musical presence of Choir, VBS, Soloists, and Drumming**
- **Continued to teach children about God’s love and desires for us as Christians**
- **Retained our talented staff and fulfilled our Outreach giving in spite of rental decreases**
- **Added completely new technology to spread our services and discussions far & wide**
- **Added back our Confirmation Class with 8 young adults plus Youth Services and more**
- **Reached new highs weekly at in-person services & starting to welcome new visitors again**
- **Grown as disciples in regular Forums, Bible Study and Book Groups**
- **Cared for our sacred space we inherited with upgrades, air filters & repairs to the church**

Doing all of the above (and more) wasn’t always easy as we’ve all learned to become comfortable with “faithful flexibility” in how we adapt within a world that hasn’t been as consistent as we’d hoped. **This is because we have Christ and we have each other. WE are Christ Church.**

As people of love and faith, we ask you to consider all for which you are thankful- your health, your family, and your community of faith. Our Stewardship co-chairs, Richard and Deanna, are asking us to return our pledge cards as soon as possible, which are combined with several important volunteer or group areas to consider as part of your Time and Talent this coming year.

Together, we take this time of thanksgiving to “praise God from whom **all** blessings flow,” and I thank God for all of you!

In Christ @ Christ Church.

Peace,

Fr. Tom